



After Being Convicted Of Voting In The 1872 Presidential Election👤📦
🔧Skill. Technical Language



Assigned by: Mr. A
Due: Oct 21, 2024 11:59 PM

📄 Learning Objectives
Text

1. DEFINE
2. MODEL
3. YOUR TURN

Define



Scene Description

Two students sit side by side in a classroom. They talk directly into the camera.

Transcript

00:00 (INTRODUCTION PLAYS)
00:05 IAN: The Clippers won in overtime with an and-one three-pointer!
00:09 CHRISTINA: Say what? IAN: I was giving you an example.
00:12 CHRISTINA: Oh of how you're a hockey geek?
00:15 IAN: Basketball, duh! And it's an example of technical language.
00:19 CHRISTINA: Oh, right.
00:20 Technical language is the specialized vocabulary
00:22 of a particular field of knowledge.
00:34 IAN: Kind of an insider shorthand.
00:36 CHRISTINA: Sometimes you can figure out the meaning by analyzing the context.
00:39 IAN: But for the most part, you gotta understand the subject that uses the term.
00:43 CHRISTINA: So if it's so particular, why do writers use it?
00:46 IAN: Uhhm, well, if I'm talking to another basketball fan
00:50 using technical language is efficient.
00:52 CHRISTINA: But what about the other ninety-eight percent of the time?
00:55 IAN: Writers use technical language for several reasons.
00:58 Technical language can educate, add precision or establish authority.
01:07 CHRISTINA: So it's not just to show off, in case any of you were wondering.
01:11 IAN: Whatever the reason, as a reader, you gotta understand what's being said.
01:14 CHRISTINA: Right, which is why texts for general readers
01:16 usually explain the technical terms.
01:18 IAN: So, uhh, do you want me to explain to you what an and-one shot is?
01:22 CHRISTINA: No, thanks. Let's summarize? Let's summarize.

Technical language refers to words that are used in certain fields of knowledge, such as astronomy or computer science. Often, understanding technical terms, especially in informational texts, means understanding something about the author’s subject. For example, if you know that an archaeologist studies human history based on things found in ancient ruins, and you read that archaeologists have discovered an important artifact, you can guess that in this context the word *artifact* refers to a thing from the ancient past. Writers include technical language to educate readers, to make their explanation more precise, or to establish their authority on a subject.

CA-CCSS: 📍 CA.RI.9-10.4
CA-ELD: 📍 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex



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SkillsTV



Scene Description

Several students sit around a table in a library. Their books, digital devices, and notebooks are out on the table. While they talk, other students work quietly in the background. Throughout the video, students step away from the group for one-on-one interviews about their discussion.

Transcript

00:00 (INTRODUCTION PLAYS) Reading Strategies

00:05 Daniela: Technical language is, like, insider-speak.

00:08 You know, like, a good way of letting people know you've got the subject down.

00:12 Ethan: I've heard of Susan B. Anthony before,

00:15 but I never knew she was put on trial for committing a crime.

00:17 Daniela: Yeah, the crime of voting.

00:19 Can you believe that?

00:20 Susie: I know, right?

00:21 In 1872, women were prohibited to vote by law.

00:24 Daniel: Wow. Did Susan B. Anthony change that?

00:27 Susie: Well, women weren't granted the right to vote until 1920.

00:31 That's almost 50 years later.

00:33 Daniela: But in this speech, Susan B. Anthony argues that

00:35 she didn't actually commit a crime.

00:37 Ethan: She claims it wasn't a crime because her right to vote

00:39 was guaranteed by the Constitution.

00:41 Daniel: Hold on. Can we all look at the text together?

00:43 Daniela: Sure. I'll read it.

00:45 "Friends and fellow citizens: I stand before you tonight under indictment

00:48 for the alleged crime of having voted at the last presidential election,

00:52 without having a lawful right to vote.

00:54 It shall be my work this evening to prove to you that in thus voting,

00:57 I not only committed no crime, but, instead, simply exercised my citizen's rights,

01:02 guaranteed to me and all United States citizens by the National Constitution,

01:06 beyond the power of any state to deny."

01:08 Daniel: "Indictment?" We might need a dictionary for this reading.

01:12 Susie: Got it covered.

01:14 Daniela: Hold on.

01:15 I think we might be able to figure out some of these words using context.

01:17 Daniel: How?

01:19 Daniela: Well, for example, the word "crime" is a clue.

01:22 Susie: What do you mean?

01:23 Daniela: I mean, she's being charged with a crime, so I think in this case,

01:27 "under indictment" might mean 'charged with?'

01:30 Susie: Hey, you're right Daniela!

01:32 It says right here: "the action or legal process

01:35 of being charged with a crime or other offense."

01:38 Daniela: "Under indictment" might mean the same thing as 'charged with'

01:41 but, in this case, the use of technical language

01:44 makes the sentence sound stronger.

01:47 You know, like, more important.

01:49 Daniel: What about the part when she says..."exercised" her "citizen's rights."

01:53 I don't think she's talking about playing tennis.

01:55 Susie: "Exercised" probably has a second meaning.

01:58 Uhh, let's look it up.

02:00 Oh, right here: it says the second meaning of exercised is

02:03 "to carry out or bring to bear."

02:06 Ethan: So, to 'exercise your rights' probably means to carry them out.

02:09 Daniela: Yeah, I guess it sounds right.

02:11 I mean, you have them: you might as well exercise them.

02:13 Daniel: But, did she have them?

02:15 Her rights, I mean.

02:17 Ethan: Absolutely, it was just a question

02:18 of getting the government to recognize them.

02:20 Daniela: Ethan, I didn't know you were a feminist.

02:23 Ethan: Hey, I'm pro-human rights.

02:25 Does that really surprise you?

02:26 Daniela: No, I guess not.

02:27 How about you read the next part?

02:29 Ethan: Sure. "For any state to make sex a qualification that must ever

02:33 result in the disfranchisement of one entire half of the people,

02:36 is to pass a bill of attainder, or, an ex post facto law,

02:41 and is therefore a violation of the supreme law of the land.

02:45 By it the blessings of liberty are forever withheld from women

02:48 and their female posterity."

02:51 Daniel: Woah, lots of technical language in there.

02:53 Ethan: I know. What's "disfranchisement" anyway?

02:56 Susie: Well, following Daniela's lead about using the context,

02:59 we can probably use this whole phrase to figure this one out.

03:01 Ethan "The disfranchisement of one entire half of the people."

03:05 'One half of the people;' that's gotta be referring to women, right?

03:10 Daniela: Yeah! So it sounds like "disfranchisement"

03:12 has something to do with denying the vote to women.

03:14 Susie: Woah, you're totally right.

03:16 'Disfranchisement' means "to deny the person or group the right to vote.

03:20 This whole examining the text thing really works.

03:23 I usually just look up words that I don't really know,

03:26 but I think trying to figure them out helps me remember them better.

03:30 Kinda cool.

03:31 Daniel: I agree. Figuring out words based on context is cool

03:34 but I don't think we're gonna have much luck

03:36 when it comes to "bill of attainder" and "ex post facto law."

03 : 40 Ethan: Huh?

03 : 42 Daniela: Well, let's look at the text.

03 : 43 What can you infer from the context?

03 : 46 Susie: So, she's referring to a 'bill' and a 'law,'

03 : 49 and it sounds like both of these can be used to keep women from voting.

03 : 53 Ethan: And so both of them violate the Constitution.

03 : 55 At least, according to Susan B. Anthony.

03 : 57 Daniela: Sounds good.

03 : 58 Look them up, Susie.

04 : 03 Susie: Umm, it says right here:

04 : 05 "a bill of attainder is a law that permits punishment without a trial."

04 : 08 Daniel: Sounds pretty unconstitutional right there.

04 : 11 Susie: And 'ex post facto' means "after the fact," which means

04 : 14 "a law that takes effect retroactively."

04 : 17 Daniel: Wow, now I need a dictionary!

04 : 20 Daniela: 'Retroactively' means you can be punished

04 : 22 for something you did before it became illegal.

04 : 24 Daniel: Wow.

04 : 26 Ethan: I know these words are hard, but it makes her sound, like, super smart.

04 : 29 Daniela: Well, yeah, not just smart but also informed;

04 : 32 like, she speaks the language of the law.

04 : 34 Daniel: Yeah, it's impressive.

04 : 36 If I were in one of those audiences, I'd be like "Yeah!

04 : 38 This woman knows her rights!"

04 : 41 Susie: What I learned today?

04 : 42 I learned that Susan B. Anthony

04 : 44 is a superhero and technical language is her secret weapon.

Model

🔊 AUDIO

✎ ANNOTATION

👁 VIEW ALL

📊 NUMBERS

1 Identification and Application:

- When reading an informational text on a particular subject, scan the text for unfamiliar words and determine whether they are technical terms.
- Note words that don't make sense in context. Sometimes common words have technical meanings in specialized contexts.
- Try to figure out the meaning from the context.
- Ask yourself, What is the subject area of the informational text? Ask subject-area experts or consult general or specialized reference materials, both print and digital, to determine or clarify the precise meaning of the technical term.Technical words usually fit into technical systems. Researching and understanding the system can help you understand each word.
- Consider how the use of technical language supports the central (or main) idea of the text.
- Try to figure out the author's purpose in using technical language. For example, legal language is used for precision in terms of the law, even though the language may be confusing to readers who are not part of the legal profession.
- Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone (e.g., how the language of a court opinion differs from that of a newspaper).

2 Model:

In her speech “After Being Convicted of Voting in the 1872 Presidential Election,” Susan B. Anthony uses technical language to strengthen her argument. For example, the text contains several words with meanings specific to government and the law. This domain-specific vocabulary educates her listeners or readers, makes her argument more precise, and establishes her authority on the subject. Consider the first paragraph:

- 3 Friends and fellow citizens: I stand before you tonight **under indictment for the alleged crime of having voted at the last presidential election**, without having a lawful right to vote. It shall be my work this evening to prove to you that in thus voting, I not only committed no crime, but, instead, **simply exercised my citizen's rights**, guaranteed to me and all United States citizens by the National Constitution, beyond the power of any state to deny. ...
- 4 The word “indictment” in the speech’s first paragraph is an example of a technical term. It relates to the law and may be unfamiliar to many readers. To figure out its meaning, begin by examining its context. For example, the word “crime” is a clue that “under indictment” might mean “charged with a crime.” However, it is probably a good idea for a reader also to consult a dictionary to verify a definition. The dictionary definition of “indictment” is “the action or legal process of being charged with a crime or other offense.” This formal definition seems weightier, more official, than the phrase “charged with.” As used in Anthony’s speech, the word “indictment” connotes the seriousness of her situation.
- 5 The word “exercised” appears in the last sentence of the first paragraph. A commonly used meaning is “took part in physical activity for health and recreation.” However, that definition makes no sense in the context of the paragraph. In Anthony’s speech, the word “exercised” means “to carry out or to bring to bear.” Here, the author is asserting that she has carried out her rights as a citizen.

- 6 Anthony moves on to analyze a paragraph of the United States Constitution and to argue that its language includes women as well as men. Since she believes that women’s rights are protected by the Constitution, she also believes that states have no right to limit them. In paragraph 5, she asserts:
- 7 For any state to make sex a qualification that must ever result **in the disfranchisement of one entire half of the people, is to pass a bill of attainder, or, an ex post facto law**, and is therefore a violation of the supreme law of the land. By it the blessings of liberty are forever withheld from women and their female posterity. ...
- 8 Knowing that Anthony’s speech addresses voting rights, a reader can determine that the phrase “disfranchisement of one half of the people” refers to denying women the vote; in fact, the term “disfranchisement” means “the act of depriving a person or group of the right to vote.” However, the terms “a bill of attainder” and an “ex post facto law” pose a greater challenge. From the text, a reader can infer that both the bill and the law could be used to disenfranchise women. Additionally, in Anthony’s opinion, both would violate the Constitution. But what exactly do these legal, technical terms mean? A dictionary indicates that “a bill of attainder” is a law that permits punishment without a trial. The term “ex post facto” means “after the fact” and refers to a law that takes effect retroactively.
- 9 Anthony’s use of strong legal language makes her sound extremely knowledgeable and authoritative on the issue of voting rights. She is simultaneously declaring herself innocent of any crime and effectively promoting a political cause--the right that women have to vote.

CA-CCSS: 📌 CA.RI.9-10.4

CA-ELD: 📌 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex



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Your Turn

Read this section (paragraphs 7-8) from “After Being Convicted of Voting in the 1872 Presidential Election” to identify technical language. Then answer the follow-up questions.

Webster, Worcester, and Bouvier all define a citizen to be a person in the United States, entitled to vote and hold office.

The only question left to be settled now is: Are women persons? And I hardly believe any of our opponents will have the hardihood to say they are not. Being persons, then, women are citizens; and no state has a right to make any law, or to enforce any old law, that shall abridge their privileges or immunities. Hence, every discrimination against women in the constitutions and laws of the several states is today null and void, precisely as is every one against Negroes.

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CA-ELD: 📌 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex

Part A

Which statement best expresses Anthony’s central (or main) idea in this section of the speech?

- ☐ A. She believes all men are entitled to citizenship.
- ☐ B. She believes the only question to be settled is whether women are persons.
- ☐ C. She believes state laws and constitutions that discriminate against women are invalid and cannot be enforced.
- ☐ D. She believes Webster is a reliable source of information.

Part B

Which sentence from this section of the speech best supports your answer to Part A?

- ☐ A. "Are women persons? And I hardly believe any of our opponents will have the hardihood to say they are not."
- ☐ B. "Being persons, then, women are citizens..."
- ☐ C. "Webster, Worcester, and Bouvier all define a citizen to be a person in the United States, entitled to vote and hold office."
- ☐ D. "Hence, every discrimination against women in the constitutions and laws of the several states is today null and void..."

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